



Adults

Q

Why must lemon juice or citric acid be added when canning tomatoes?



Adults

ANSWER

To ensure safety by increasing acidity and preventing bacterial growth

FUN FACT

Tomatoes are borderline acidic, so acid must be added to prevent botulism.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



Q

How much bottled lemon juice should be added per quart jar of canned tomatoes?



Adults

ANSWER

2 tablespoons

FUN FACT

Bottled lemon juice is preferred because its acidity is consistent.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



Q

What is the required headspace when canning tomatoes in jars?



Adults

ANSWER

1/2 inch

FUN FACT

Proper headspace prevents overflow and ensures a good seal.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



Q

Why should tested recipes be followed exactly when canning salsas?



ANSWER

Changing ingredients can alter acidity and processing times, causing unsafe products

FUN FACT

Salsa recipes have been scientifically tested to guarantee safety.

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes



Q

What must be done to tomatoes before canning to help remove skins safely?



Adults

ANSWER

Dip in boiling water for 30 to 60 seconds until skins split, then cold water to slip skin off

FUN FACT

Scalding on boiling water loosens tomato skins for easy removal.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



Q

When canning salsa with hot peppers, what safety precaution is recommended?



Adults

ANSWER

**Wear plastic or rubber gloves
and avoid touching your face**

FUN FACT

*Capsaicin in hot peppers can cause
irritation if it contacts skin or eyes.*

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes



Q

What cooking method is commonly used before filling jars with salsa for canning?



Adults

ANSWER

Heat to a boil and simmer for specified time, e.g., 10-20 minutes

FUN FACT

Heating salsa destroys spoilage organisms and ensures safety.

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes



Q

What is the recommended acid to use when canning salsa containing tomatoes or tomatillos?



Adults

ANSWER

Bottled lemon juice or lime juice

FUN FACT

Only bottled juices guarantee consistent acidity needed for safety.

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes



Q

How long should tomatoes be simmered before filling jars when making spaghetti sauce for canning?



Adults

ANSWER

20 minutes uncovered

FUN FACT

Simmering reduces volume and concentrates flavors.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



Adults

Q

What is the effect of adding salt to canned tomatoes?



Adults

ANSWER

Salt is added for flavor only and does not preserve the food

FUN FACT

Salt can be omitted if desired since it does not impact safety.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



Q

What can happen if you do not follow altitude adjustments in processing times for canned tomatoes?



ANSWER

Microorganisms may survive causing spoilage or unsafe food

FUN FACT

Higher altitudes require longer processing times or higher pressure.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



Q

What is the reason for avoiding overripe or frost-killed tomatoes in canning?



Adults

ANSWER

They can result in poor quality and potentially unsafe products

FUN FACT

Using firm, ripe tomatoes ensures a better texture and safety.

Source: SP 50-920 Preserving tomatoes



Q

What is the recommended processing method for tomatoes packed raw without added liquid?



Adults

ANSWER

Boiling water canner or pressure canner with 1/2 inch headspace and added acid

FUN FACT

Raw packing tomatoes requires acid and proper heat to be safe.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



Q

What is the correct amount of citric acid to add per pint jar for canning tomatoes?



Adults

ANSWER

1/4 teaspoon

FUN FACT

*Citric acid is a reliable acidifier
alternative to lemon juice.*

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



Q

When canning tomato-based salsas, what is the typical processing time in a boiling water canner at 0-1000 ft altitude?



Adults

ANSWER

15 minutes for pints

FUN FACT

Processing times ensure heat reaches all parts of the jar for safety.

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes



Q

Can you safely increase the amount of onions, celery, or peppers in a tested tomato spaghetti sauce recipe?



Adults

ANSWER

No, increasing these can affect acidity and safety

FUN FACT

Changing proportions in tested recipes can make the product unsafe.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



Q

What is the advised way to pack tomatoes with okra or zucchini for canning?



Adults

ANSWER

Use about 3 pounds of tomatoes to 1 pound of okra or zucchini and follow tested processing times

FUN FACT

Mixing vegetables with tomatoes needs careful balance for safety.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products



Q

What should be done after processing jars in a boiling water canner before removing them?



Adults

ANSWER

Remove canner from heat, wait 5 minutes, then remove jars

FUN FACT

Waiting prevents jar breakage due to sudden temperature changes.

Source: SP 50-768 Tomatillos



Q

What headspace is required when canning hot salsa recipes?



ANSWER

1/2 inch headspace

FUN FACT

Correct headspace allows for expansion and proper sealing.

Source: SP 50-1003 Laws of salsa with recipes



Q

What is the safest way to peel chile peppers for salsa recipes before canning?



Adults

ANSWER

Blister the skin using an oven, broiler, or range top then slip off skins

FUN FACT

Blistering makes pepper skins easy to remove and improves texture.

Source: PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products